

BAAZ & UDAY JKBOSE

2026 CLASS 11TH

We're Not Afraid to Die

LECTURE-02

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

- 1 “We’re Not Afraid to Die...if we Can All Be Together”
- 2 ...
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“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”

Gordon Cook and Alan East



**“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”**

In July 1976, my wife Mary, son Jonathan, 6, daughter Suzanne, 7, and I set sail from Plymouth, England, to duplicate the round the-world voyage made 200 years earlier by Captain James Cook.

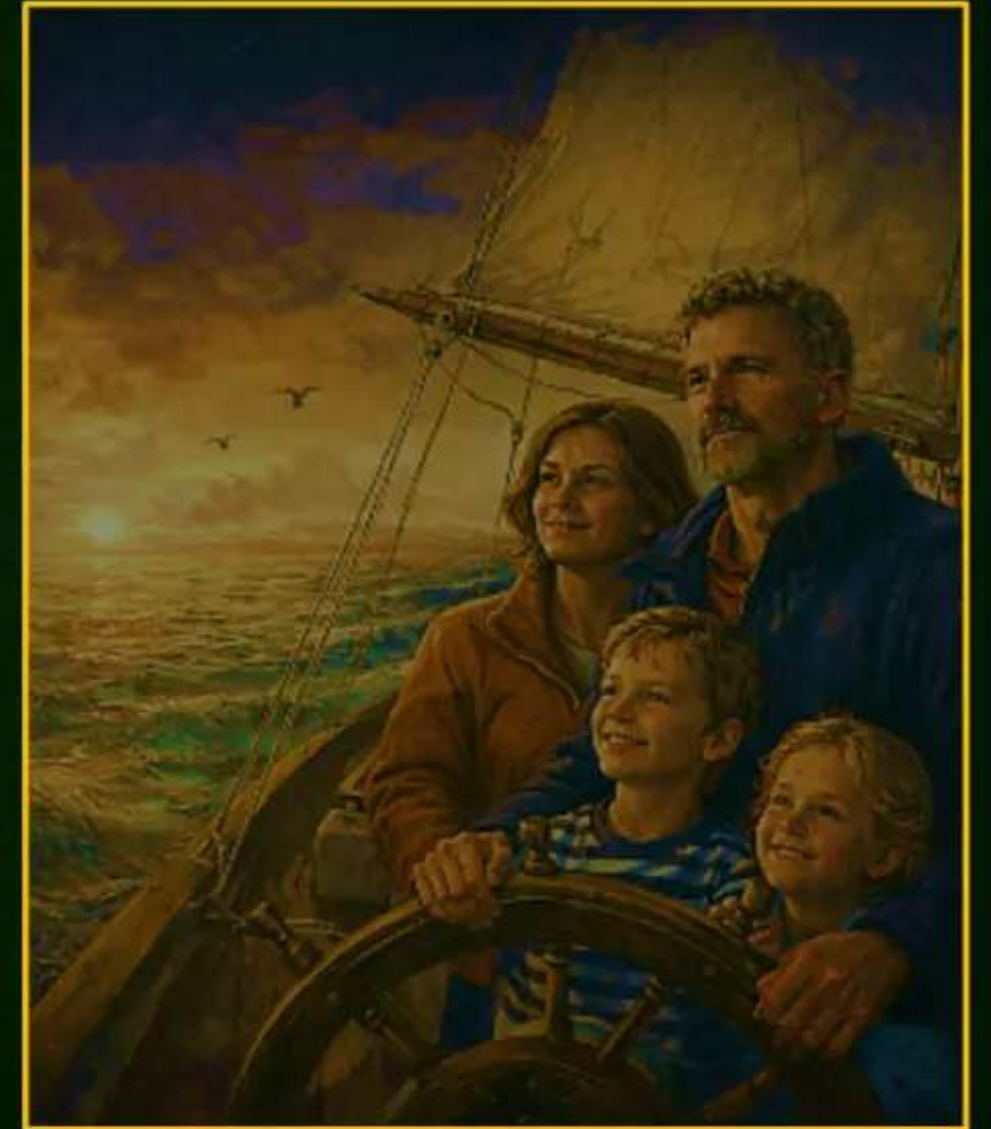
For the longest time, Mary and I — a 37-year-old businessman — had dreamt of sailing in the wake of the famous explorer, and for the past 16 years we had spent all our leisure time **honing our seafaring skills** in British waters.

set sail: to begin a journey by sea

duplicate: repeat

in the wake of : following

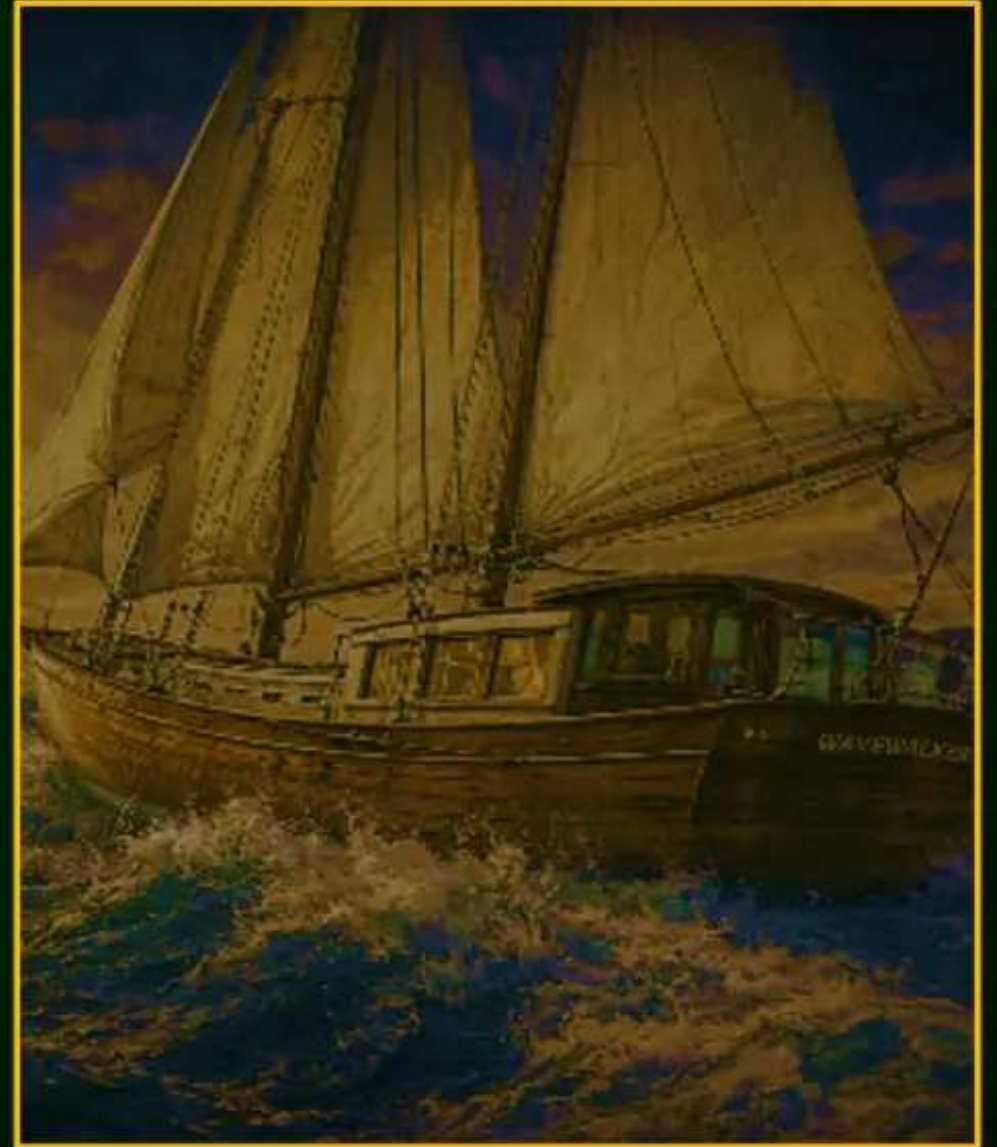
honing: improving



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
if we Can All Be Together”

Our boat Wavewalker, a 23 metre, 30 ton wooden-hulled beauty, had been professionally built, and we had spent months fitting it out and testing it in the roughest weather we could find.

*wooden-hulled: outer body
of the ship made of wood*

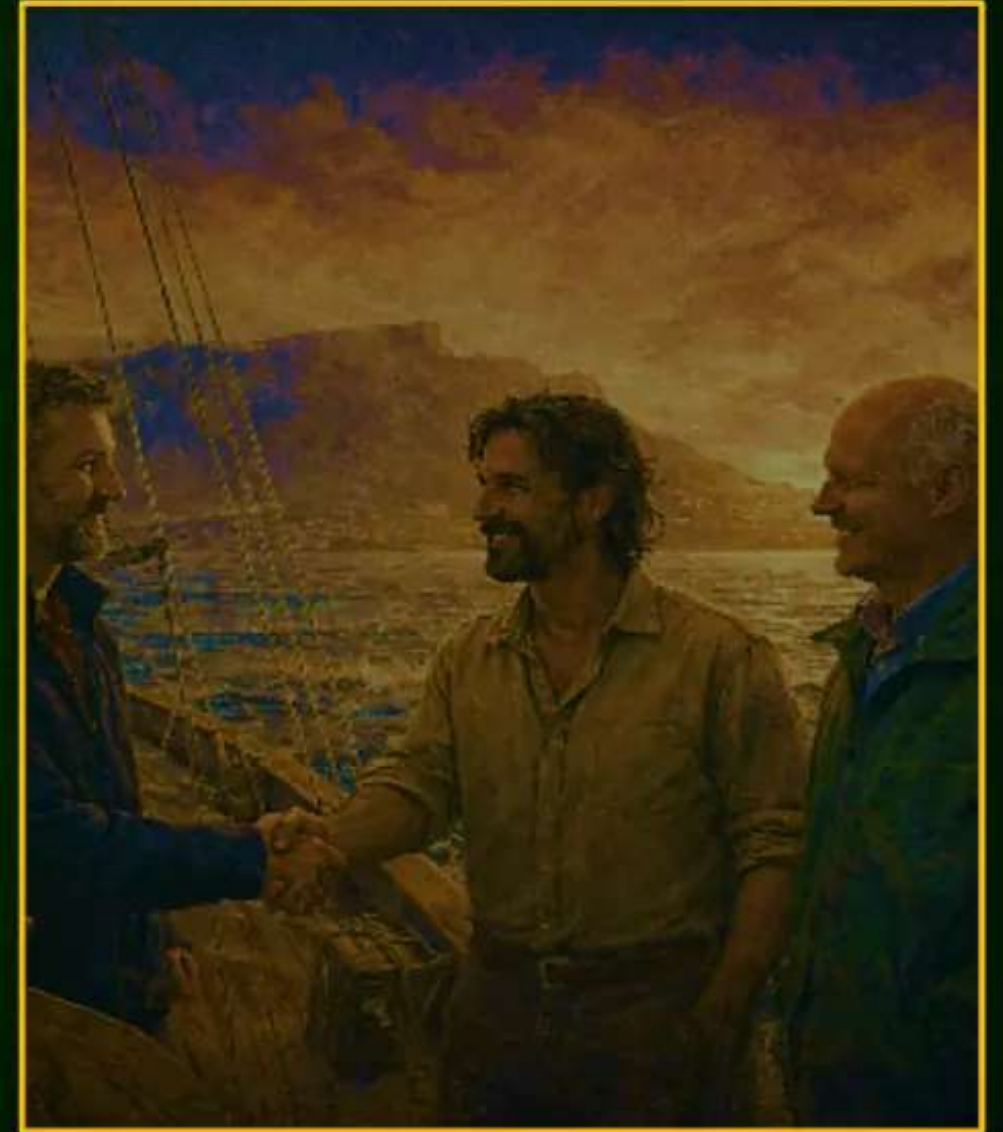


“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

The first leg of our planned three-year, 105,000 kilometre journey passed pleasantly as we sailed down the west coast of Africa to Cape Town. There, before heading east, we took on two crewmen – American Larry Vigil and Swiss Herb Seigler – to help us tackle one of the world’s roughest seas, the southern Indian Ocean.

leg: one part of a journey

crewmen: men to work on the ship



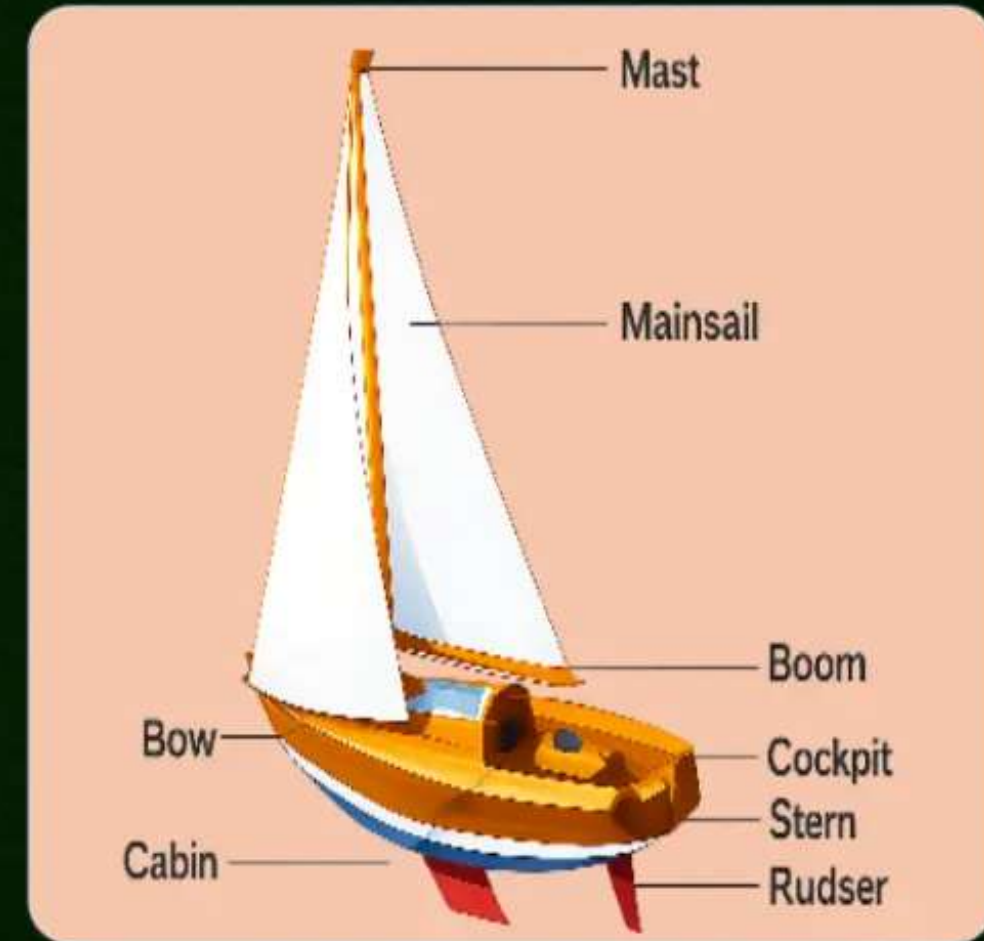
“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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On our second day out of Cape Town, we began to encounter strong gales. For the next few weeks, they blew continuously.

Gales did not worry me; but the size of the waves was alarming — up to 15 metres, as high as our main mast.

gales: strong winds

mast: a tall upright poll



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December 25 found us 3,500 kilometres east of Cape Town. Despite atrocious weather, we had a wonderful holiday complete with a Christmas tree. New Year’s Day saw no improvement in the weather, but we reasoned that it had to change soon. And it did change — for the worse.

atrocious: extremely bad



QUESTION

Who is the narrator of the story?

- A** Gordon Cook
- B** Alan East
- C** Jonathan
- D** Suzanne

QUESTION

What was the name of the narrator's boat?

- A** Odyssey
- B** Wavewalker
- C** Seawalker
- D** Voyager

QUESTION

What was the main aim of the narrator's voyage?

- A** Trade journey
- B** Scientific research
- C** Round-the-world sea voyage
- D** Fishing expedition

QUESTION

Name the two crewmen who joined the family.

- A** Larry Vigil and Herb Seigler
- B** Larry Vigil and John
- C** Herb and Alan East
- D** John and Herb Seigler

“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

At dawn on January 2, the waves were gigantic. We were sailing with only a small storm jib and were still making eight knots. As the ship rose to the top of each wave we could see endless enormous seas rolling towards us, and the screaming of the wind and spray was painful to the ears. To slow the boat down, we dropped the storm jib and lashed a heavy mooring rope in a loop across the stern. Then we double-lashed everything, went through our life-raft drill, attached lifelines, donned oilskins and life jackets — and waited.

stern: back part of the ship

life-raft drill: practicing how to climb into a life Boat if the main Boat sinks.

donned: wear



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

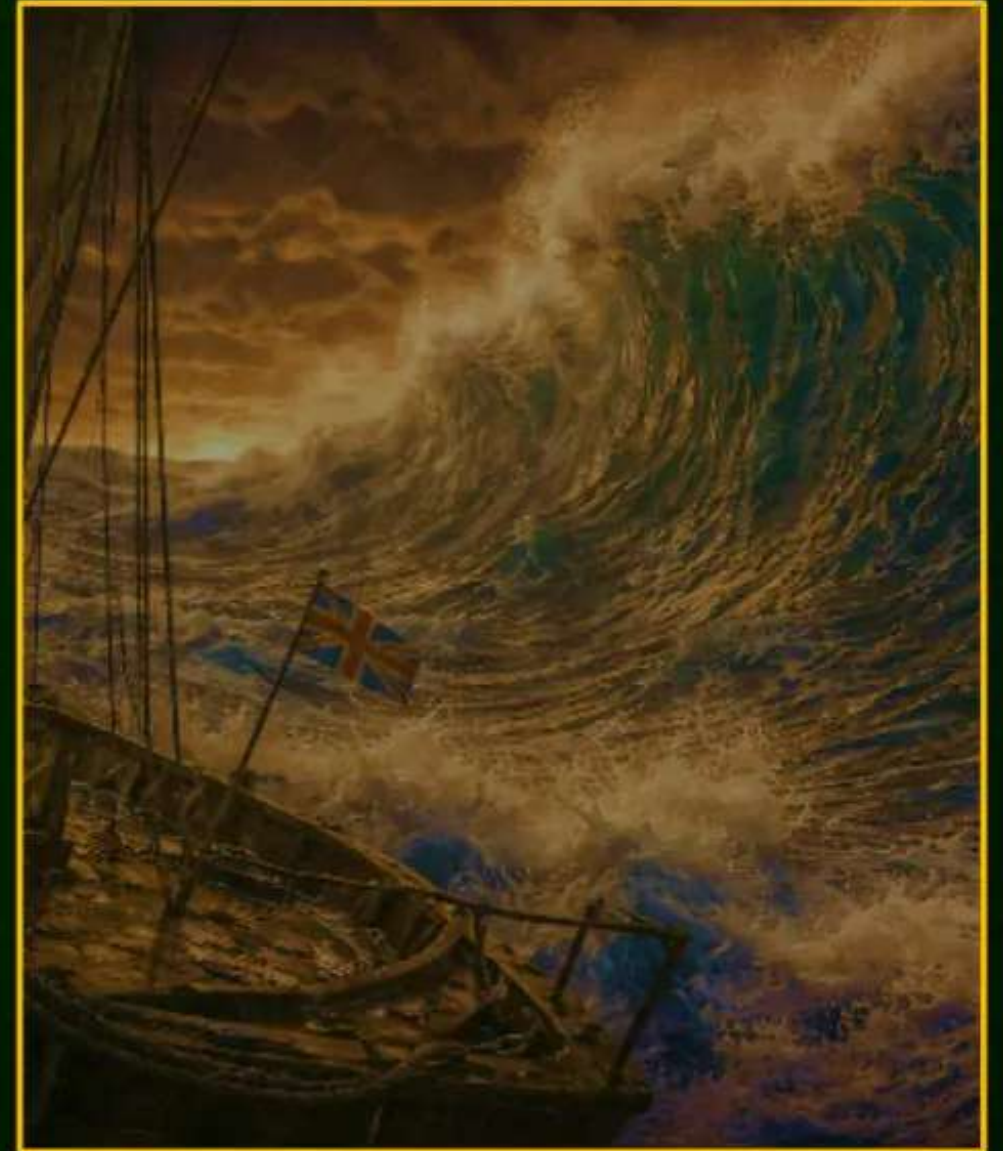
The first indication of impending disaster came at about 6 p.m., with an ominous silence. The wind dropped, and the sky immediately grew dark. Then came a growing roar, and an enormous cloud towered aft of the ship. With horror, I realised that it was not a cloud, but a wave like no other I had ever seen. It appeared perfectly vertical (straight) and almost twice the height of the other waves, with a frightful breaking crest.

impending: about to happen

ominous: threatening

aft of the ship: near or toward the stern of a ship

breaking crest: where the top of a wave collapses and the wave breaks



“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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The roar increased to a thunder as the stern moved up the face of the wave, and for a moment I thought we might ride over it. But then a tremendous explosion shook the deck. A torrent of green and white water broke over the ship, my head smashed into the wheel and I was aware of flying overboard and sinking below the waves. I accepted my approaching death, and as I was losing consciousness, I felt quite peaceful.

deck: floor of the ship
torrent: large amount



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

Unexpectedly, my head popped out of the water. A few metres away, Wavewalker was near capsizing, her masts almost horizontal. Then a wave hurled her upright, my lifeline jerked taut, I grabbed the guard rails and sailed through the air into Wavewalker’s main boom. Subsequent waves tossed me around the deck like a rag doll. My left ribs cracked; my mouth filled with blood and broken teeth. Somehow, I found the wheel, lined up the stern for the next wave and hung on.

popped out : come out suddenly

capsizing: overturn

hurled: to throw something with great force

taut: pulled tightly

Subsequent: coming after or later

tossed: up down

hung on: held the boat tightly



QUESTION

Why did the crew drop the storm jib and lash a heavy mooring rope across the stern?

- A** To increase the speed of the boat
- B** To change the direction of the ship
- C** To slow the boat down
- D** To repair the sail

QUESTION

What made the wind and spray painful to the ears?

- A** The cold temperature
- B** The height of the waves
- C** The screaming sound of the wind and spray
- D** The movement of the boat

QUESTION

Why did the narrator feel horror on seeing the approaching wave?

- A** It was moving very slowly
- B** It looked like a dark cloud
- C** It was unusually tall and perfectly vertical
- D** It was smaller than the other waves

QUESTION

What happened to the narrator after the tremendous explosion?

- A** He was thrown into the cabin
- B** He jumped into the sea
- C** He safely held the wheel
- D** He was washed overboard and began to sink

QUESTION

What alarming news did Mary give the narrator

- A** The ship was sinking and full of water
- B** The sails were torn
- C** The engine had failed
- D** The crew was injured

QUESTION

What injury did Sue complain about?

- A** A broken arm
- B** A bump on her head
- C** A deep cut
- D** A twisted ankle

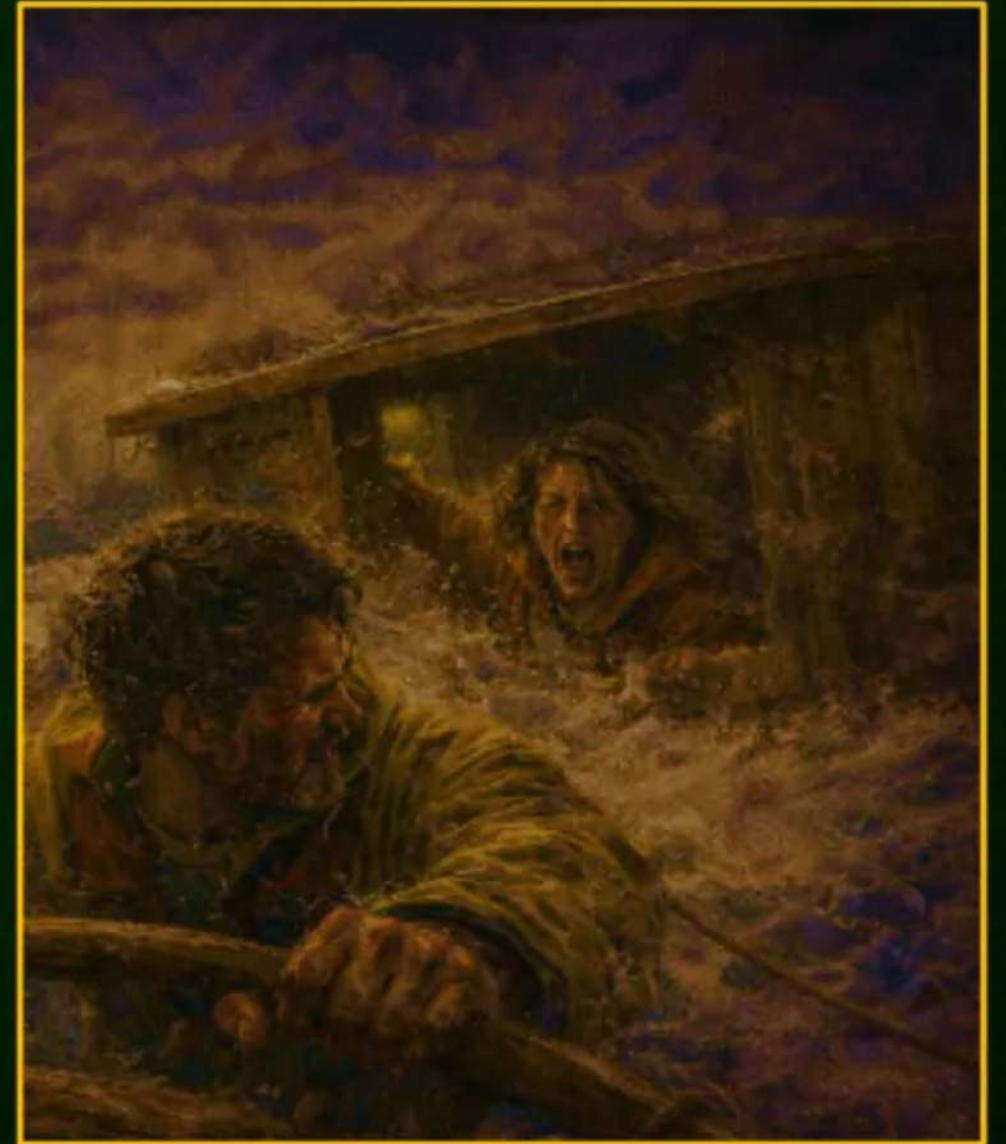
“We’re Not Afraid to Die...
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Water, Water, Everywhere. I could feel that the ship had water below, but I dared not abandon the wheel to investigate. Suddenly, the front hatch was thrown open and Mary appeared. “We’re sinking!” she screamed. “The decks are smashed; we’re full of water.”

“Take the wheel”, I shouted as I scrambled for the hatch.

hatch: door

scrambled: to move somewhere quickly



"We're Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together"

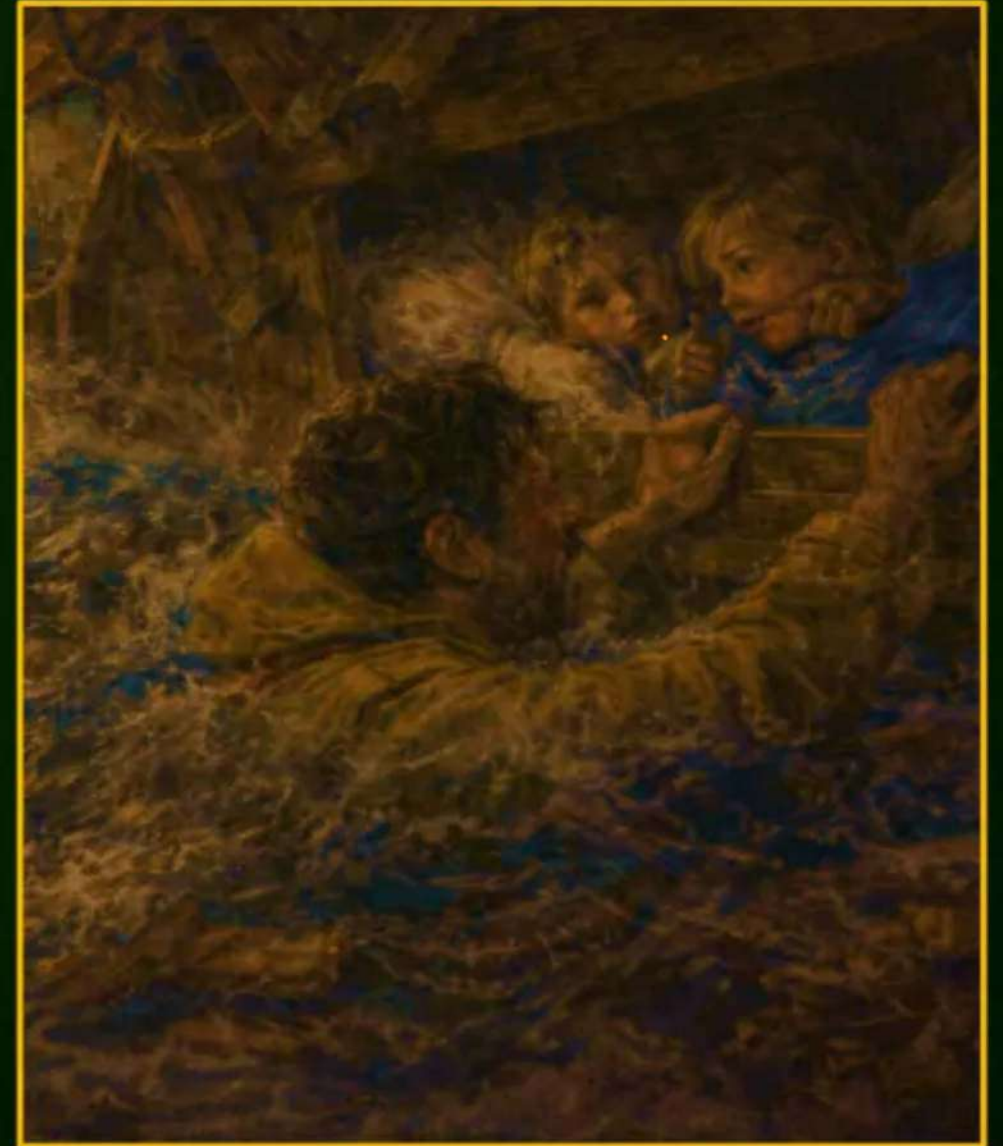


Larry and Herb were pumping like madmen. Broken timbers hung at crazy angles, the whole ^{right side} starboard side bulged inwards; clothes, crockery, charts, tins and toys sloshed about in deep water.

I half-swam, half-crawled into the children's cabin. "Are you all right?" I asked. "Yes," they answered from an upper bunk.

"But my head hurts a bit," said Sue, pointing to a big bump above her eyes. I had no time to worry about bumped heads.

starboard side: right side of the ship
sloshed: to move around noisily inside
upper bunk: the top bed in a bunk bed



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

After finding a hammer, screws and canvas, I struggled back on deck. With the starboard side bashed open, we were taking water with each wave that broke over us. If I couldn’t make some repairs, we would surely sink.

Somehow I managed to stretch canvas and secure waterproof hatch covers across the gaping holes. Some water continued to stream below, but most of it was now being deflected over the side.

deflected: turned aside



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More problems arose when our hand pumps started to block up with the debris floating around the cabins and the electric pump short-circuited. The water level rose threateningly. Back on deck I found that our two spare hand pumps had been wrenched overboard — along with the forestay sail, the jib, the dinghies and the main anchor.

wrenched: damaged

forestay sail: a type of rope to support

dinghies: small boats



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Then I remembered we had another electric pump
under the chartroom floor. I connected it to an out-
pipe, and was thankful to find that it worked.

The night dragged on with an endless, bitterly cold
routine of pumping, steering and working the radio.
We were getting no replies to our Mayday calls —
which was not surprising in this remote corner of
the world.

Mayday calls : distress messages sent over the radio



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Sue’s head had swollen alarmingly; she had two enormous black eyes, and now she showed us a deep cut on her arm.

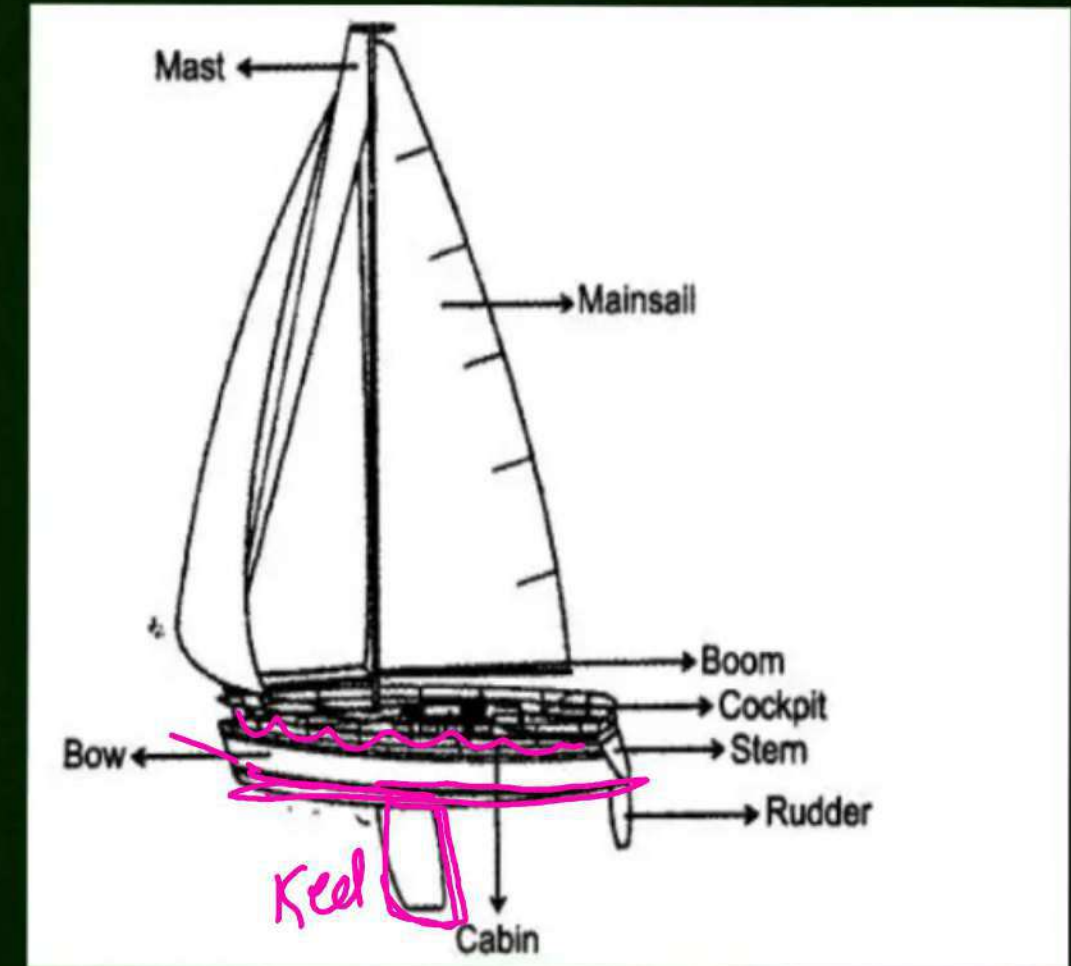
When I asked why she hadn’t made more of her injuries before this, she replied, “I didn’t want to worry you when you were trying to save us all.”



“We’re Not Afraid to Die... if we Can All Be Together”

By morning on January 3, the pumps had the water level sufficiently under control for us to take two hours’ rest in rotation. But we still had a tremendous leak somewhere below the waterline and, on checking, I found that nearly all the boat’s main rib frames were smashed down to the keel. In fact, there was nothing holding up a whole section of the starboard hull except a few cupboard partitions.

keel: a long piece of wood or metal on the bottom of a boat that stops it falling over sideways in the water
starboard hull: the right side of the body (hull) of a ship or boat

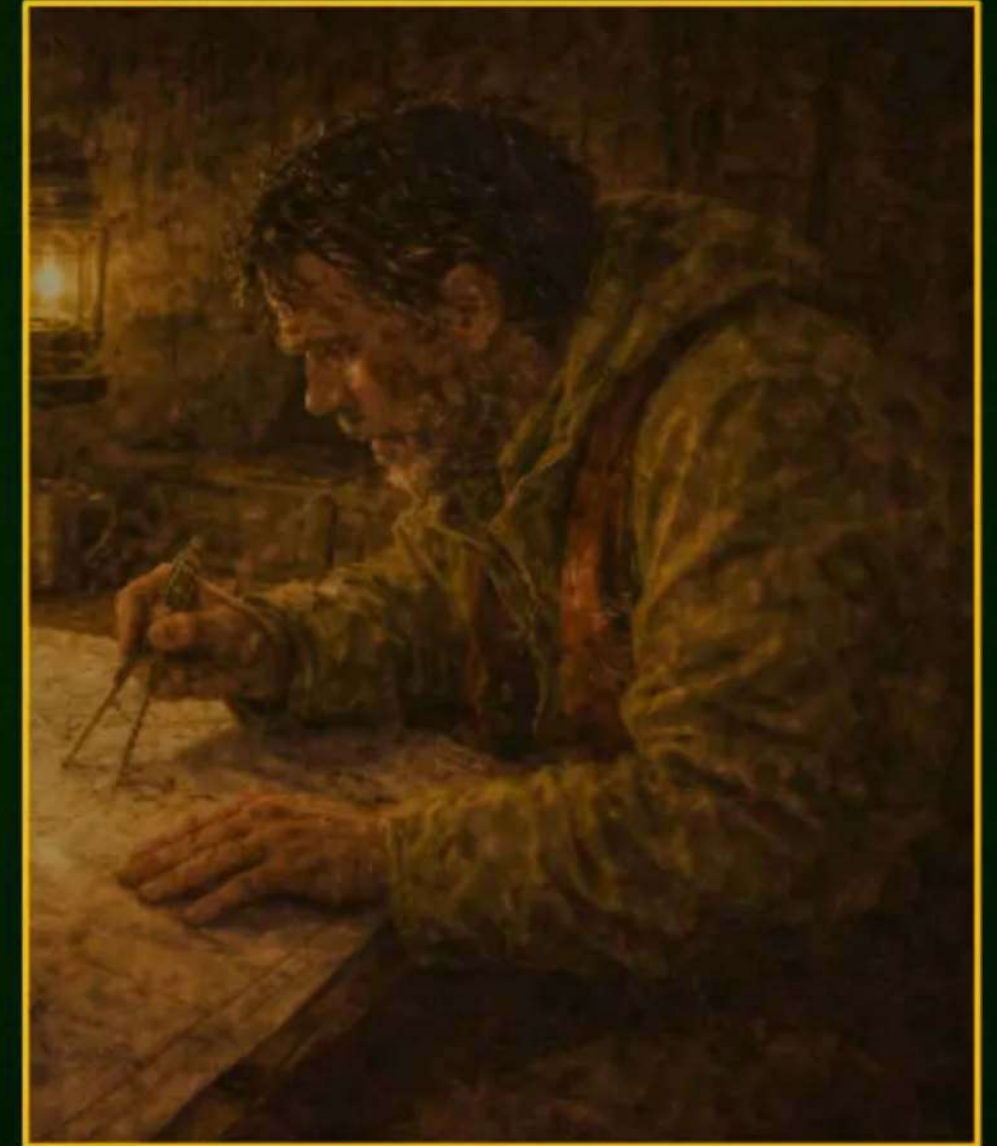


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We had survived for 15 hours since the wave hit, but Wavewalker wouldn't hold together long enough for us to reach Australia. I checked our charts and calculated that there were two small islands a few hundred kilometres to the east. One of them, Ile Amsterdam, was a French scientific base. Our only hope was to reach these pinpricks in the vast ocean. But unless the wind and seas abated so we could hoist sail, our chances would be slim indeed. The great wave had put our auxilliary engine out of action.

abated: stop

auxilliary engine : supporting engine



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On January 4, ^{36 hours} after 36 hours of continuous pumping, we reached the last few centimetres of water. Now, we had only to keep pace with the water still coming in. We could not set any sail on the main mast. Pressure on the rigging would simply pull the damaged section of the hull apart, so we hoisted the storm jib and headed for where I thought the two islands were.

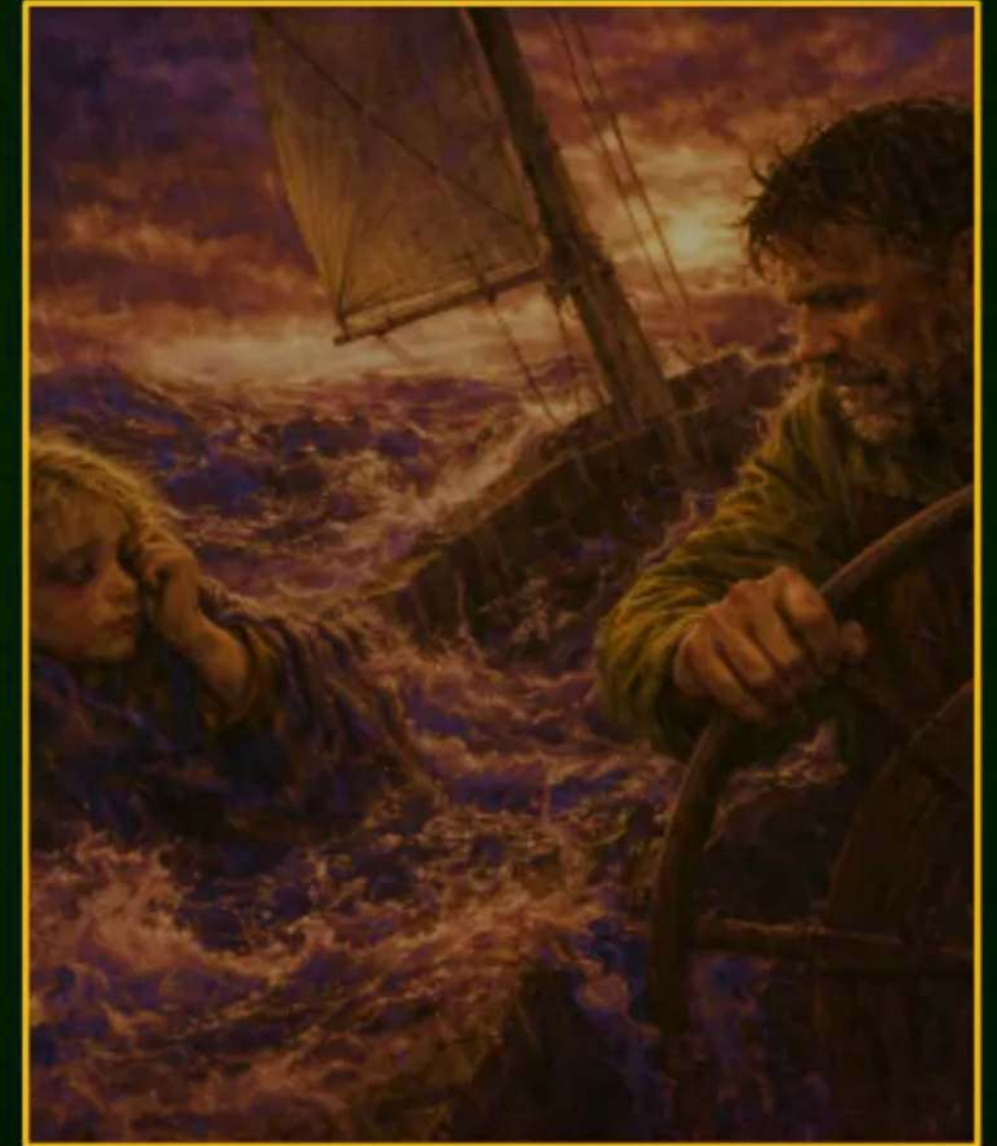
Mary found some corned beef and cracker biscuits, and we ate our first meal in almost two days.

rigging: ropes that balance the mast of the boat



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But our respite was short-lived. At 4 p.m. black clouds began building up behind us; within the hour the wind was back to 40 knots and the seas were getting higher. The weather continued to deteriorate throughout the night, and by ^{early morning} dawn on January 5, our situation was again desperate.



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When I went in to comfort the children, Jon asked, “Daddy, are we going to die?” I tried to assure him that we could make it. “But, Daddy,” he went on, “we aren’t afraid of dying if we can all be together — you and Mummy, Sue and I.”



QUESTION

What did the narrator use to cover the gaping holes in the hull?

- A** Tarpaulin and nails
- B** Canvas and waterproof hatch covers
- C** Wood and glue
- D** Plastic sheets

QUESTION

Why did water keep coming into the boat?

- A** The hull was damaged and hand pumps were blocked
- B** The sea was calm
- C** The sails were torn
- D** The anchor was broken

QUESTION

Which pump saved the crew when the first ones failed?

- A** Main engine pump
- B** Electric pump under the chartroom floor
- C** Auxiliary hand pump
- D** None

QUESTION

On 3rd January, what did the narrator discover about the ship?

- ☐ A The sails were intact
- ☒ B Nearly all the main rib frames were smashed down to the keel
- ☐ C The hull was completely fine
- ☐ D d) The ship had no leaks

QUESTION

By 4th January, how many hours of continuous pumping had the crew done?

- A** 12 hours
- B** 24 hours
- C** 36 hours
- D** 48 hours

Thank
You